

	EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY	POLICY NUMBER	704
	A Division of the Merced County Department of Public Health	Effective Date	11/2025
Authority: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, and California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, 1797.220		Initial Date:	07/2022
		Review Date:	10/2028

CHEST PAIN / DISCOMFORT
ADULT
Substernal chest pain, chest or epigastric discomfort, heaviness, squeezing, burning or tightness, pain radiating to or isolated to jaw, shoulders, arms or back, nausea, diaphoresis, dizziness, dyspnea, anxiety, or back pain.
BLS
Assess Vitals / Obtain SpO ₂ / Oxygen - Titrate to SpO ₂ of 94% or higher / Secure Airway - Assist Ventilations if needed. Aspirin (ASA) - 324 mg PO - ASA is not contraindicated with the history of anticoagulant use - ASA is contraindicated with signs of ACTIVE GI bleeding If SBP ≥ 100 mmHg EMTs may assist a patient with their prescribed Nitroglycerin sublingual tablets or spray: Nitroglycerin - 0.4 mg SL - May repeat every 5 minutes - Max dose 1.2 mg or three (3) total doses
Base Hospital Physician Orders Only
Contact Base Hospital before administering Nitroglycerin to patients taking Viagra (Sildenafil) or similar erectile dysfunction drugs within the past six (6) hours.
ALS
Follow BLS procedures if applicable. Obtain 4-Lead ECG and 12-Lead ECG - Perform a 12-Lead ECG within ten (10) minutes - If the 12-Lead ECG reads STEMI, Acute MI, or equivalent; transmit the 12-Lead ECG to appropriate STEMI Receiving Center Keep scene times < 15 minutes. If SBP ≥ 100 mmHg: Nitroglycerin - 0.4 mg SL - May repeat every 5 minutes - Max dose 1.2 mg or three (3) total doses Vascular Access - IV/IO rate as appropriate. If patient continues to have chest pain after Nitroglycerine - Refer to EMS Policy #718 - Pain Management
Base Hospital Physician Orders Only
Contact Base Hospital before administering Nitroglycerin to patients taking Viagra (Sildenafil) or similar erectile dysfunction drugs within the past six (6) hours.

Signatures on File

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